PROFILE ▼

A SPACE of FREEDOM

***Kader Attia*, the first non-Indian curator of the Kochi Biennale, believes in collaboration and creating bridges between communities**



NICOLO MIANA

Colonialism refuses to become history. Memory cannot be archived. How can repair ever be 'complete' when ancient wounds continue to stalk us? When Algerian-French artist Kader Attia curated the Berlin Biennale in 2022, many reached for an easy classification—'decoloniality'—ignoring the fact that he has always resisted linear time. Multiple fissures run through his work: who can define civilisation, significance, aesthetics, and expertise? By incorporating fractured perspectives—oral histories and unofficial records—he disrupted the authority of western institutions at the Berlin Biennale. But Attia, the first non-Indian curator of the Kochi-Muziris Biennale, smiles at the first question.

"Don't you think it is a bit too early to disclose the key elements of my curatorial vision for KMB 2027? But yes, I want to draw from the city's history and focus on creating bridges between communities, between Kochi and the rest of the world, in the real world—as opposed to the digital one. It is important to generate spaces of freedom where dialogue and

ATTIA DESCRIBES KOCHI AS A HARBOUR SHAPED BY CENTURIES OF EXCHANGE WHERE HUMAN CONNECTIONS HAVE BLENDED IN TO CREATE A MULTI-LAYERED CULTURE



ART ▼

Data Diaries

NEW WORK BY THUKRAL & TAGRA EXPLORES WHAT IT MEANS TO REMAIN HUMAN IN DIGITAL TIMES

During the pandemic, Delhi-based artist duo Jiten Thukral and Sumir Tagra—better known as Thukral & Tagra—conceived a new body of work called Arboretum. It emerged from a preoccupation with the natural environment and the way technology had become inseparable from how we perceive it. Ideas of glitch and data began to shape their ways of seeing trees and they designed the wooden structures themselves, bars carved directly into the frame as integrated hanging devices.

The residue this process left behind has resulted in *Mimesis*, their new exhibition that explores how lived moments are translated into pixels, bars and fragmented visual units. "As our days